

Harvey Brown

Senior Game Designer

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I'm a cross-disciplinary Senior Game Designer with experience working in Systems, Game and Technical Design roles, with a strong technical background, and experience leading and producing major game updates for best selling games on PC, Console, Mobile and VR.

I have led small and medium sized feature and prototyping teams as well as serving as product owner for whole games and major gameplay features from initial product ideation through to post-launch support and DLC.

I strive for intuitive gameplay and UX with deep mechanical depth. I enjoy roles where I can wear multiple hats, with a wide range of skills from 3D modeling, VFX, graphics programming, software engineering and programming, granting me the flexibility to meet the requirements of any project.

WORK HISTORY

nDreams Orbital & Compass - Senior Game Designer (Technical + Systems), 2022 - 2026

- Main systems designer for a first-of-its-kind GaaS, Multiplayer, Systems Driven Game for VR Meta Quest, focused on sustained retention, and player agency and self expression
- Designed and implemented AI systems and interaction subsystems for a sandbox exploration game, Wreckin' Raccoon. Provided support for early access and post-launch development.
- Product owner for multiple new game and IP initiatives, pitching and prototyping gameplay from a rough vision, to a concrete for implementation based on high level specifications and director feedback
- Drafted detailed technical evaluations and ran event storming sessions building clarity on the requirements for a live service backend for a systems and simulation heavy live service game
- Ran multidisciplinary strike teams focused on rapidly iterating early core game loops in Unreal Engine, and developing key deliverables for major project milestones

Ndemic Creations - Technical Game & Systems Designer, 2019 - 2022

- Led design and production for major game updates, including; 3 maps, 8+ scenarios, a campaign mode and a weekly challenges system, for games played by over 160 million players worldwide
- Implemented strategies for highly successful Early Access PC development
- Managed multidisciplinary feature teams in a highly agile development environment to deliver dozens of successful gameplay updates and DLC for existing and new products
- Managed PC and Mobile storefronts, overhauled the companies data analytics and managed the companies policies on Data Integrity and GDPR
- Worked on the design of the highly successful "Cure Mode" DLC for Plague Inc. Featured by the World Health Organization (WHO) and Coalition for Epidemic Preparedness Initiative (CEPI).
- Collaborated with fact checking organizations Full Fact and Politifact to create accurate, educational and fun representations of the spread of misinformation in a "Fake News" scenario update
- Mentored junior designers through the creation of their first gameplay contributions

EDUCATION

University of Southampton

- BSc Computer Science 2015 - 2018
- MEng Computer Science 2018 - 2019

SKILLS

- Gameplay & Technical Design, Systems & Economy Design, Design Documentation, Software Engineering, Linear Algebra, Programming, Analytics and Data Vis, 3D Blockout and Modeling, VFX and shaders, Graphics Programming, Optimization, Onboarding and FTUE Design, Narrative Design
- **Engines, Languages & Tools** - Unity, Unreal, Godot, OpenGL/GLEW/GLFW, SDL2, Bullet Physics, Blender, Photoshop, Affinity Designer, Krita, GLSL/HLSL, Niagara, Blueprints, C#, C++, JS/TS, Excel/Google Sheets, Jira, Asana, Miro, Apache Lucene, Elastic Kibana, AWS Graphana

GAME DEVELOPMENT PROJECTS

Wreckin Raccoon (VR Sandbox with Emergent Interactive Gameplay)

- Designed emergent interaction subsystems and implemented dozens of individual complex interactive objects for a VR interaction sandbox
- Implemented semi-emergent state-based AI architecture for the games antagonist NPC
- Created the gameplay analytics dashboards, working with the nDreams shared technology group to create reusable analytics dashboards for future nDreams titles

Compass Gameplay Prototypes (Racing and Movement games, Novel gameplay mechanics)

- Pitched and led the development of a series of small to medium sized game prototypes with a focus on simple but engaging VR-first gameplay with novel gameplay mechanics

Project Zeus (VR GaaS, Cooperative Multiplayer, Survival/Farming Hybrid Game)

- Designed and implemented the economy for a VR live service title aimed at the Quest 2 headset
- Managed project wide systems design for strict hardware and server constraints
- Implemented tooling and workflows for automated data generation and testing, improving the speed and reliability of economy iteration

After Inc. (Indie Simulation Strategy, PC and Mobile)

- 1 Year developing gameplay and IP for new strategy game from Ndemic Creations
- Huge financial success, with 100k downloads in its first 3 months

Scenario Creator (Standalone modding toolkit for Rebel Inc)

- Led the design and development of an official standalone modding toolkit for the rebel inc strategy game, used to create and share thousands of user-created games through an online platform
- Oversaw QA, Beta testing, public documentation and successful rollout of the highly anticipated app
- Wrote custom JavaScript tooling to assist with large data management

Rebel Inc (Counter Insurgency Strategy, 2 DLC, Early Access Roadmap, New Game Modes)

- Led design and development of dozens of minor to medium sized updates launched during Rebel Inc's early access period, pushing the game to a successful 1.0 launch in 2022, selling 200-300k copies on PC maintaining at 80-90% steam rating with 10+ million downloads on mobile
- Overhauled games analytics, creating analytics dashboards and managing GDPR compliance
- Led design and production of a procedural strategy-roguelike progressive campaign, which rapidly became our second highest grossing IAP on mobile, generating 30+% of total revenue at launch
- Developed a weekly challenge mode using globally-seeded random generation, driving community engagement through time-limited challenges, with negligible server overhead
- Oversaw the implementation of 2 paid DLC and dozens of free content updates